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Unsettling news about that snooze

Study links certain daytime naps in older adults to higher health risks

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

For many people, the occasional “power nap” is one of life’s small pleasures. But when a midday snooze becomes a daily necessity, it may be your body trying to tell you something.

A recent study led by researchers at Mass General Brigham and Rush University Medical Center in Chicago found that older adults who have a pattern of long, frequent naps, especially in the morning, may have underlying health conditions.

The federally funded study published this month tracked 1,338 adults age 56 and older using wrist-worn activity monitors beginning in 2005. Researchers said nearly all participants napped. The cohort was predominantly

white, with an average age of 81 years.

The researchers found that each additional nap per day was associated with a 7 percent higher risk of death, each additional hour of daytime napping raised that risk by 13 percent, and people who tended to nap in the morning had a 30 percent higher mortality risk than afternoon nappers.

That doesn’t mean naps are dangerous. Research shows naps can boost memory, focus, and creativity, and they’re culturally accepted in many countries, including Spain, Italy, China, and Japan. The problem is when napping becomes excessive or starts creeping into the morning, said the study’s lead author, Chenlu Gao, a researcher in the Department of Anesthesiology at

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ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Research shows naps can boost memory and creativity. The problem is when napping becomes excessive.

FBI seeks ties among missing scientists

But others say connections unlikely and warn against adding to ‘social brittleness’

By Nick Stoico and Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

What began as an apparent conspiracy theory — unconfirmed speculation that the deaths or disappearances of at least 10 scientists may be connected — is now the subject of a federal investigation.

The FBI said in a statement Tuesday that it is “spearheading the effort to look for connections into the missing and deceased scientists,” two of whom were from Massachusetts. Many of the scientists reportedly had access to sensitive information, including on nuclear weapons, officials said.

A day earlier, Republican leaders of the House Oversight Committee said they are seeking information from several federal agencies, including NASA, the Department of Energy, and the Department of Defense, “about the scientists and other personnel connected to U.S. nuclear secrets or rocket technology who have died or mysteriously vanished in recent years.”

While any links among the cases remain unconfirmed, the reports “raise questions about a possible sinister connection” among them, the Republican lawmakers said.

“If the reports are accurate, these deaths and disappearances may represent a grave threat to U.S. national security and to U.S. personnel with access to scientific secrets,” Republican Represent-

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WHAT’S THE STORY?



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Student Layla King stole the show at the end of a book reading at Horizons for Homeless Children Friday in Boston. Representatives Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez of New York (from left) and Ayanna Pressley of Massachusetts joined Boston Mayor Michelle Wu in reading to children at the center. **B1.**

Response to nude performance is revealing

By Mark Shanahan
GLOBE STAFF

The Museum of Fine Arts posted photos on Instagram Thursday of a partially nude performance artist walking through its galleries, and the reaction among the museum’s 500,000 followers was, well, not indifference.

“Wtf is this nonsense?” wrote one commenter.

“Seriously? So vulgar,” wrote another.

“This is absolutely ridiculous!” seethed yet another. “This is not fine art. I may reconsider membership.”

To be fair, not everyone who saw the photos on social media of Xandra Ibarra strolling through the MFA objected. Indeed, many enjoyed them and found it

amusing that art lovers who can appreciate the bodacious nudes of Botticelli could be so offended by the sight of an actual human female in the museum.

“If your response to a woman’s body is disgust, you’re immature & have some growing to do,” replied one woman on Instagram.

“Bostonians, clutching their pearls per usual,” said another.

Ibarra is among 12 contemporary artists whose work is featured in the new MFA exhibition, “Take Back the Nude: Subvert, Repair, Reclaim,” a collection of multimedia works that contemplate issues of objectification, exploitation, and erasure in relation to female nudity in Western art history.

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TIM CORREIRA PHOTOGRAPHY

Xandra Ibarra performed her piece “Nude Laughing” at the MFA.

Brisk assessment

Saturday: Chilly, clouds and sun.
High: 48-53. Low: 41-46.

Sunday: Clouds then sun, warmer.
High: 50-55. Low: 40-45.

High tide: 6:39 a.m. 7:28 p.m.

Sunrise: 5:48 Sunset: 7:37

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C10.**

The Justice Department has dropped a criminal investigation into the Federal Reserve after months of probing the independent central bank’s \$2.5 billion building renovations. **A2.**

The Iran war has significantly drained much of the US military’s global supply of munitions, and forced the Pentagon to rush

bombs and other hardware to the Middle East from commands in Asia and Europe. **A3.**

Citizens Bank is facing two class action suits after customers were impacted by a data breach. **D2.**

The Celtics hit some huge three-pointers late to stop Philadelphia and take a 2-1 lead in their series. **C1.**

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Vt. courts give new chance to repeat offenders

Similar program eyed for Mass. and Cass area

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

RUTLAND, Vt. — Dillon Wortman’s life of drug use and petty theft is memorialized in police reports with the kind of frustrating regularity familiar to residents of cities that have long battled homelessness and addiction.

There he is in surveillance videos stripping copper piping from a local business, or slipping food into his backpack at the grocery store. And each police report contains a version of the same refrain by the arresting officer: “I immediately recognized one of the suspects as Dillon Wortman ... from a previous theft investigation.”

So when a shackled Wortman, 32, entered a courtroom in downtown Rutland in March, he might’ve expected Judge Susan McManus to throw the book at him. Instead, she threw him a lifeline.

Before contemplating jail time, the judge would close the courtroom and let McManus meet privately with a small cadre of social service providers there to help him stay sober, find stable housing, and rebuild his life.

“The idea,” McManus told Wortman, was to address his underlying needs “so that you don’t keep coming back here.”

Wortman was among the first defendants in Rutland to go through Vermont’s so-called ac-

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PAUL HEINTZ/GLOBE STAFF